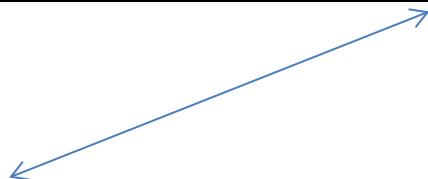


The Formation of the Passive Voice

The passive voice can only be formed with transitive verbs i.e. verbs which take an OBJECT!

ACTIVE

SUBJECT	VERB	OBJECT	Other Info
The company	employs	500 people	in Bochum



PASSIVE

OBJECT becomes Subject	TO BE (tense!)	Past Participle VERB	BY agent	Other Info
500 people	are	employed	by the company	in Bochum

Read through the following info boxes.

Info Box Active Verbs

transitive verbs in the active have a **SUBJECT + VERB + OBJECT**

The **SUBJECT** carries out/controls the verb

Look at the following examples:

He updates the website every week

He is updating the website now

He will update the website later on today

He updated the website yesterday

He was updating the website when the computer crashed

He had updated the website just before the computer crashed

He has just updated the website

Info Box The Passive Voice

used when the object of the sentence becomes the main focus

passive sentences have the **OBJECT + VERB (in passive)**
(+ by **SUBJECT**)

Look at the following examples:

The website is updated (by him) every week

The website is being updated (by him) now

The website will be updated (by him) later on today

The website was updated (by him) yesterday

The website was being updated (by him) when the computer crashed

The website had been updated (by him) just before the computer crashed

The website has just been updated (by him)



Info Box The Passive Voice with modals in the present

Common modal verbs are

can/could/ be able to must/have to

should/ought to would

Look at the following examples:

He can/should update the website every week.

The website can be updated (by him) every week

Exercises: convert the following active sentences into the passive form:

1. The company will launch the new product range later this year.

The company is launching the new product range later this year.

2. The hotel employs 50 more kitchen and service staff during the summer season every year.

The hotel is employing 50 more kitchen and service staff during the summer season every year.

3. The man was driving the van too fast when the accident happened.

When the accident was happening, the man was driving the van too fast.

4. Bank customers must use a PIN when withdrawing cash from an ATM.

Bank customers must be using a PIN when withdrawing cash from an ATM.

5. The company made a big profit last year.

The company was making a big profit last year.

6. You should pay the invoice within 30 days.

You should be paying the invoice within 30 days.

7. She has already completed the marketing campaign for the new products.

The marketing campaign for the new products has already been completed.

Grammar Worksheet 2

The Passive Voice



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8. The manager is updating the customer data base at the moment.

The customer base is being updated by the manager at the moment.

9. The entrepreneur had to take out a loan to manage the cash flow problems they had last year.

A loan to manage the cash flow problems they had last year had to have been taken by the entrepreneur.

10. Account holder A had authorized the bank to transfer the money to B.

The bank transferring the money has been authorized by Account holder A.

11. The airline is not offering any special deals at the moment.

no special deals are being offered by the airline

12. They have not built the new production hall yet.

the new production hall hasnt been build yet

13. She will not employ any new people for the next 6 months.

no new people will be employed by her

14. Can we book the tickets on the website?

can the tickets be booked on the website

15. Is he going to fix the photocopier today?

is the copier going to be fixed by him today

16. Did they raise the prices by 5% or 6% last month?

were the prices raised by them

17. Has she told Mr. Smith that he has got the job?

has mr smith been told

18. You should have changed this sentence into the passive.

this sentence shoulve been changed ...